— Professional services, projects and billing

What to fix, in order.

Your score is the share of severity-weighted checks you passed: critical checks count 3 points, significant 2 and hygiene 1. Bands run Solid (85% and up), Workable (65 to 84), Material exposure (45 to 64) and At risk (under 45). One critical failure caps you at Material exposure, and three cap you at At risk.

57%

of severity-weighted checks passed

Material exposure

Enough is wrong that the next audit, close or release will find some of it for you.

Passed	9
Failed	5
Not sure	2
Critical failures	2

Start at the top. The queue is ordered by severity first and effort second, so the first item is the most damage you can remove for the least work, not the most interesting problem.

01 **Can anyone approve their own time or expenses, through a delegation, a role assignment, or an unfilled approver step?** CHECK 05 1 to 2 days

Why it matters. This is the first thing an auditor tests in a services business, and an unfilled approver step that auto-advances counts as a failure even if nobody has used it.

The fix. Close the self-approval paths, review delegations, and make sure no approval step can auto-advance when the approver is empty.

SUGGESTED OWNER: PROJECTS LEAD

02 **Is unbilled reviewed by age, with anything genuinely unbillable written off on a schedule?** CHECK 11 | 1 to 2 days

Why it matters. Stale unbilled is an asset that will never convert to cash. It flatters the balance sheet until someone makes you clear it in one quarter.

The fix. Age it, set a write-off policy with a named approver, and work the backlog down before it becomes a single large correction.

SUGGESTED OWNER: CONTROLLER

03 **Is there a review step between the draft invoice and the customer, owned by someone who did not do the work?** CHECK 08 | Hours

Why it matters. Disputes are far more expensive than review. An invoice that goes out wrong costs the relationship as well as the cash.

The fix. Add a billing review step with a named owner and a short checklist of what they are looking for.

SUGGESTED OWNER: BILLING MANAGER

04 **Is every production configuration change in this area matched to an approved ticket each month?** CHECK 14 | Hours to set up

Why it matters. Change management is a standard audit test. If you cannot produce the full list of changes and tie each one to an approval, the auditor widens testing, and the matching eats days of someone's month.

The fix. Agree one change list and which change types are in scope, require a ticket reference for each change, and name who signs off each month.

SUGGESTED OWNER: FINANCIAL SYSTEMS ADMINISTRATOR

05 **When a change order lands, does it amend the contract in the tenant, or does someone adjust the invoice by hand?** CHECK 02 | 1 to 2 days

Why it matters. Manual invoice adjustments do not flow to recognition, so revenue and billing drift apart quietly and the gap is discovered in an audit rather than in a report.

The fix. Route change orders through a contract amendment, and stop allowing manual invoice edits as the fix.

SUGGESTED OWNER: REVENUE MANAGER

Cannot be answered yet

Go and look at these before deciding anything. Each one is either a pass you can bank or a failure you have not met yet.

? **Is there a hard cut-off for time entry, and does anything actually stop entry after it?**

Where to look. Ask when time for last month was due, then check whether any time was entered for that month after the date.

? **Are expenses billed against the contract terms, including markup and any category exclusions, without a person remembering the rules?**

Where to look. Take a recent expense-heavy invoice and check it against what the contract permits.

— What this cannot do

It found the problems. It cannot fix them.

The health check finds problems but can't scope the fix, because the fix depends on your configuration, your award count and your close calendar. If three or four items come back critical, the free scoping call is the cheapest next step. The $3,500 diagnostic comes after that.

The Billing Leakage Review is two weeks and a fixed $3,500, ending in a ranked findings list with a named owner against each item. The findings stand whether or not you hire me for the fix. If your score above is comfortable, you don't need it.

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